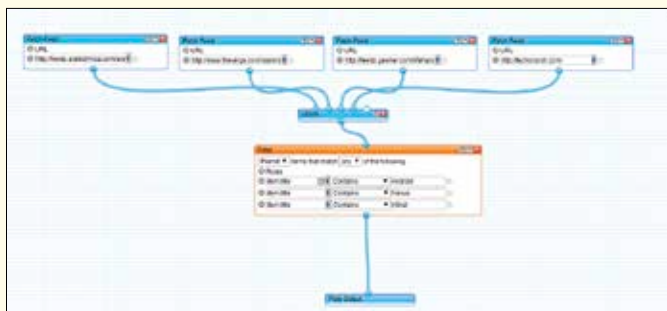




Yahoo Pipes is a tool that lets you combine your newsfeeds like a boss, through intelligent filters

and not “Block” on the top left. Once you’ve added the filters of your choice, connect the output of the Filter to the Pipe Output and save your pipe. You’ll get a “Pipe Saved” message at the top, along with a Run Pipe... link. Click on it and you’ll see the status of your pipe. If all goes well, you’ll be able to export your Pipe as an RSS feed or as a JSON file.

Zapier

IFTTT is great for automating tasks that involve text-based or image-based data, such as Facebook posts, tweets or emails. However, if you find yourself looking to move around files and folders, or you’re looking for a more business-focussed service for your SME needs, take a look at Zapier. It includes enterprise-grade services such as Amazon’s S3, DynamoDB, Basecamp, Mailchimp, etc. The catch is that it’s a paid service with a free tier that gives you upto five zaps, but they trigger only once every five hours.



Backup files from Dropbox to Google Drive

Dropbox and Google Drive both have their strengths, and

if you want to backup your data redundantly across both services, this simple “zap” will do the job for you. Sign up for Zapier and select Dropbox with “New file in directory” as your trigger and Google Drive with “Copy file from trigger” as the action.

Once you authenticate your accounts, you’ll be asked to specify which folder in Dropbox you want monitored. We’ve chosen the /Photos folder, as Dropbox automatically backs up photos from your Digital Camera’s SD card when you plug it in. Next, specify the destination folder in your Google Drive, along with parameters such as the filename. If you’re uploading documents, you might want to turn on the automatic file conversion to make your documents editable in Google Docs.



Sync your Base CRM contacts with Mailchimp

Base is a popular Customer Relationship Management tool used by small businesses, and Mailchimp is a leading provider of Email newsletter and email analytics. Syncing your contacts between these

two services is almost a no brainer! Create a new zap with the trigger as a new contact in Base, with the action being adding a new subscriber to your Mailchimp account.

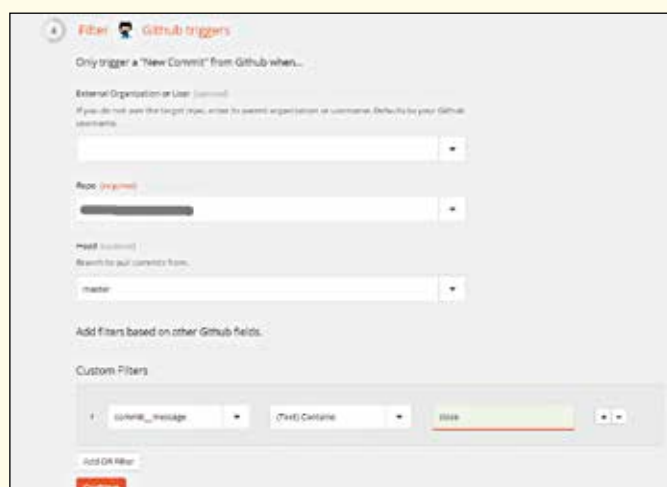


Automatically share new blog posts on FB / Twitter

If you maintain a blog, you probably also want to be able to share it with your friends on Facebook and Twitter. This zap monitors you blog’s RSS feed, and creates a new post in Buffer every time you add a new blog post. This way, you can have Buffer send out your tweets or

words like “close” in the commit message of every commit made to a Github repository, and sends an email informing people of the change. This is particularly handy if you have a number of developers collaborating on a project, as it keeps everyone up to date on the status of an important bug fix or feature enhancement.

In the trigger, select Github, authorize your account, and specify the repository and the branch you wish to monitor. You can add filters to match only a special type of commit, and specify the email addresses of those you want to inform.



Filter Github triggers to stay on top of what you’re doing

status updates at an optimum time when they’ll be visible to the majority of your friends and followers. You’ll need to have an account with Buffer (it’s free) to enable posting via Buffer. This zap should work irrespective of your blog host (Blogger / Wordpress / Tumblr) as it only uses the blog’s RSS feed. Alternatively, you can use it to share updates to any interesting blogs you follow.

These certainly aren’t the only automation tools out there on the web. If you’re privacy conscious and fairly tech-savvy, check out Huginn (<https://github.com/cantino/huginn>) which is a system that lets you build “agents”, each like an IFTTT or Zapier action that can continuously monitor the web. You can use it to scrape websites for information for great shopping deals, or check Twitter for trending topics that interest you. It’s very powerful, but you need to host it yourself on your server with Ruby installed. Smaller examples are Boomerang, (<http://www.boomeranggmail.com>) that lets you schedule emails for a later date



Zapier takes the concept of IFTTT to a whole new level



Inform your team of bugfixes to a Github repository

This zap is one that Wade Foster, the co-founder of Zapier claims to use himself. It checks for key-